

Thabani Biyela, ACA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Chartered Accountant (ACA) and MSc Computer Science graduate with 8+ years of finance experience. Big 4 trained with 4+ years post qualification experience in multinational and service-orientated environments. Recognised as a subject matter expert with a strong command of accounting and finance principles. Technologically adept with proficiency in SQL, JavaScript, and Python, as well as advanced use of the MS Office Suite and Google Cloud Platform tools such as BigQuery, Looker Studio, and Apps Script.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Platform Analyst

January 2024—Present

Just Eat Ireland Limited (Just Eat Takeaway.com)

Dublin, Ireland

Senior platform analyst in the central platform accounting and insights team responsible for revenue recognition and analytics in Just Eat Takeaway.com's European markets. Just Eat Takeaway is a Dutch multinational online food ordering and delivery company which operates various food ordering and delivery platforms in 20 countries.

- Application of IFRS (especially IFRS 15) accounting policies and recording of transactions relating to business events recorded on the company's order management system. Review and analyse partner (B2B) and consumer (B2C) terms and conditions relating to business streams to determine the appropriate revenue recognition treatment.
- Leads the timely completion of complex month-end closing including supporting and guiding two junior team members. This includes preparation and review of journals, reconciliations, and KPI reporting.
- Represents the finance function in cross-functional teams integrating new products and markets into the company's order management and finance systems. Translates accounting requirements into test scenarios and develops scripts to automate testing and validate financial data and system outputs.
- Builds and maintains relationships with stakeholders. Revenue accounting's main point of contact for internal and external stakeholders, including country finance leads, group reporting, business partners, country accounting and external auditors.
- Development of interactive dashboards and visualisations to present financial insights to stakeholders.
- Initiation, development and maintenance of data pipelines and data models that power journal postings, account reconciliations and dashboards. These support financial processing for a platform facilitating 140m+ annual orders, each generating multiple revenue streams requiring transformation, enrichment, and reconciliation to the general ledger.
- Leads continuous improvement initiatives for revenue and platform accounting. Designed and implemented a cloud-based accounting automation solution using Python, DBT (SQL, Python), and Google BigQuery to harmonise financial data and automate data processing. The solution reduced manual processing by 390 labour hours annually.
- Control owner for relevant SOX controls.

Executive Accountant

May 2021—December 2023

BASF Services Europe GmbH

Berlin, Germany

Executive accountant in the financial reporting department of the shared services centre responsible for the EMEA group of BASF Companies. BASF is a German multinational company and the largest chemical producer in the world.

- Timely and accurate execution of monthly, quarterly and annual closing according to IFRS.
- Accountant in charge of overseeing and supporting a team of accountants during a heavy period of service on-boarding. This involved analysing client processes, completing fit-gap and feasibility analysis, coordinating with other departments, and reviewing and preparing procedure documentation and service/operating level agreements.
- Subject matter expert recognised as a contact for internal enquiries to clarify financial reporting issues. Prepared and presented training sessions to the wider team and department relating to accounting matters and the implementation of new tools.

EXPERIENCE (continued)

Senior Auditor

May 2019—April 2021

Auditor

October 2017—April 2019

Deloitte Ireland LLP

Dublin, Ireland

Senior auditor in the financial services audit department of Deloitte Ireland responsible for the timely and efficient planning and execution of audits for a portfolio of regulated entities in the investment management (fund) industry.

- In conjunction with engagement management, planned, managed, and executed the timely performance of statutory audits including group audits.
- Prepared client communication documentation including the audit planning memorandum and audit summary memorandum for presentation at client Board meetings.
- Reviewed the financial statements prepared under US GAAP or IFRS and ensured that the financial statements were prepared in accordance with the relevant financial reporting standard. Ensured the financial statements contained the necessary disclosures in relation to applicable laws and regulations (Companies Act 2014, AIFMD, UCITS, ICAV Act 2015, etc.).

EDUCATION

Master of Science Computer Science

University of London (Birkbeck), Distinction

October 2022—October 2025

Completed Master of Science (MSc) with Distinction in Computer Science degree at the University of London. For my final year project I designed and implemented a cloud-based data architecture to standardise and automate the platform accounting processes within a large-scale digital marketplace processing hundreds of millions of transactions annually.

Associate Chartered Accountant

Institute of Chartered Accountants Ireland

September 2017—September 2020

Qualified Associate Chartered Accountant with Chartered Accountants Ireland. Strong academic record having passed all institute exams on first attempt.

B.B.S. (LANG) Business Studies and German

Trinity College Dublin, II.1

September 2013—May 2017

Completed the Business Studies and German programme with a II.1 grade. My third year of university was spent at the University of Regensburg in Germany where the majority of modules and examinations were taken through German.

SKILLS

- **Languages:** English (Native), German (C1)
- **MS Office:** MS Excel (including Power Query), MS Word, MS Powerpoint.
- **Google Cloud Platform:** Google BigQuery, Google Looker Studio, Google Apps Script.
- **Programming Languages:** Python (including Pandas), SQL, and JavaScript.
- **Developer Tools:** Git Version Control, Visual Studio Code, Jupyter Notebook.
- **Accounting:** Chartered accountant with proven technical accounting knowledge in IFRS.